

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1139

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor the Negro Women's Civic Club of
Greeneville on the occasion of its seventy-fifth
anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we pay tribute to those exemplary organizations that work
with purpose and conviction to improve the quality of life in their respective communities; and

WHEREAS, one such esteemed organization is the Negro Women's Civic Club of
Greeneville, which celebrated its seventy-fifth anniversary on February 21, 2026; and

WHEREAS, founded on June 11, 1950, the Negro Women's Civic Club of Greeneville
was established at a time when segregation was in effect throughout the South, but many
people organized in order to promote better communities for all—no matter the color of one's
skin; and

WHEREAS, in Greeneville, Lena B. Lee organized a group of seven other women: Annie
Carter, Carris Robinson, Georgia B. Campbell, Hannah Crum, Evelyn Perkins, Lucille Martin,
and Ezell Gillespie to found the local Negro Women's Civil Club with a motto to build a better
Greeneville; and

WHEREAS, some of the founders of the Negro Women's Civic Club were teachers,
preachers' wives, and domestic workers; one of the club's founders, Hanna Farnsworth-Crum,
donated the present building and property to the club in 1981; and

WHEREAS, the Negro Women's Civic Club has been dedicated to serving the needs of
the Black community of Greeneville through various charitable and developmental initiatives and
actively supporting local businesses, churches, and community projects; and

WHEREAS, over the decades, the Negro Women's Civic Club has provided Christmas
food baskets and other items to those in need, granted scholarships to graduating seniors,
hosted voter registration drives, and established youth recreational programs; and

WHEREAS, shortly after the club's founding, members began work raising funds to build a swimming pool for the Black community, which was barred from the Town of Greeneville's community pool; the new pool was opened in August of 1954 in front of George Clem School, which served as a segregated educational facility for the Black community at the time; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we recognize one of Tennessee's oldest women's clubs on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the Negro Women's Civic Club of Greeneville on the occasion of its seventy-fifth anniversary, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.